FUEL TANK INSULATOR INSTALLATION

AFFECTED VEHICLES: **CERTAIN 1997 THROUGH 2001 MODEL YEAR E-150 WAGONS, E-350 WAGONS, AND E-350 VANS WITH AMBULANCE PREP PACKAGES EQUIPPED WITH 35 GALLON MID-SHIP FUEL TANKS**

OVERVIEW

This procedure provides the instructions for installing two (2) insulator pads on the top of the fuel tank, one at each location where the tank contacts the frame crossmembers. If a fuel tank is found to be cracked, contact the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 for directions.

SERVICE PROCEDURE

WARNING!

DO NOT SMOKE OR CARRY LIGHTED TOBACCO OR OPEN FLAME OF ANY TYPE WHEN WORKING ON OR NEAR ANY FUEL-RELATED COMPONENT. HIGHLY FLAMMABLE MIXTURES ARE ALWAYS PRESENT AND MAY BE IGNITED, RESULTING IN POSSIBLE PERSONAL INJURY.

WARNING!

FUEL IN THE FUEL SYSTEM REMAINS UNDER HIGH PRESSURE, EVEN WHEN THE ENGINE IS NOT RUNNING. BEFORE REPAIRING OR DISCONNECTING ANY OF THE FUEL LINES OR FUEL SYSTEM COMPONENTS, THE FUEL SYSTEM PRESSURE MUST BE RELIEVED TO PREVENT ACCIDENTAL SPRAYING OF FUEL, CAUSING PERSONAL INJURY OR FIRE HAZARD.

FUEL TANK REMOVAL

1. Disconnect the battery ground cable.
2. Remove the engine cover.
3. Using EFI/CFI Fuel Pressure Gauge 310-012 (T80L-9974-B) or equivalent, relieve the fuel system pressure, then remove the gauge.
4. Raise and support the vehicle on a hoist.
5. Using High-Lift Transmission Jack 014-00942 or equivalent, support the fuel tank and remove the fuel tank strap nuts.
6. Disconnect the fuel filler tube and vent tube from the hoses at the fuel tank.
7. Partially lower the fuel tank to gain access to and remove the rear vapor valve.
8. Using Rotunda Fuel Storage Tanker 164-R3201 or equivalent, drain the fuel tank through the vapor valve opening.
9. Disconnect the front vapor valve tube.
10. Disconnect the fuel pressure and return lines at the pump.

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11. Disconnect the fuel pump and pressure transducer electrical connectors.
12. Remove the fuel tank from the vehicle and set it on the ground or suitable workbench.

FUEL TANK INSPECTION

1. Inspect the top of the fuel tank in the areas that come into contact with the frame crossmembers for visible cracks or fuel stains which would indicate a crack. See Figure 1.

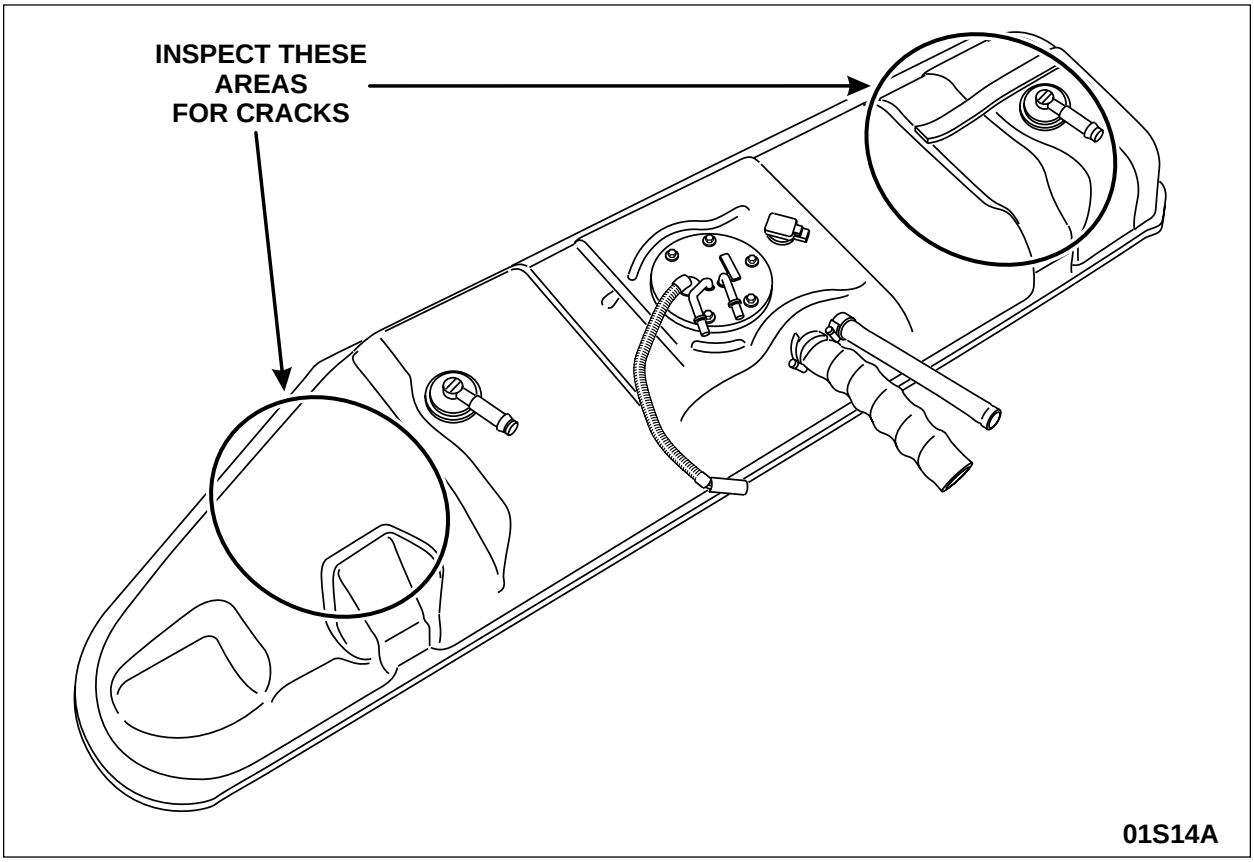

FIGURE 1

2. If no cracks or evidence of a leak are found, proceed to INSULATOR INSTALLATION.
3. If any cracks are present, contact the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 for directions.

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INSULATOR INSTALLATION

1. Clean all dirt and debris from the top of the fuel tank in the two affected areas.
2. Peel the backing off the insulator pads and install them on the fuel tank approximately 40 mm (1-1/2 in) from the tank seam. See Figure 2.

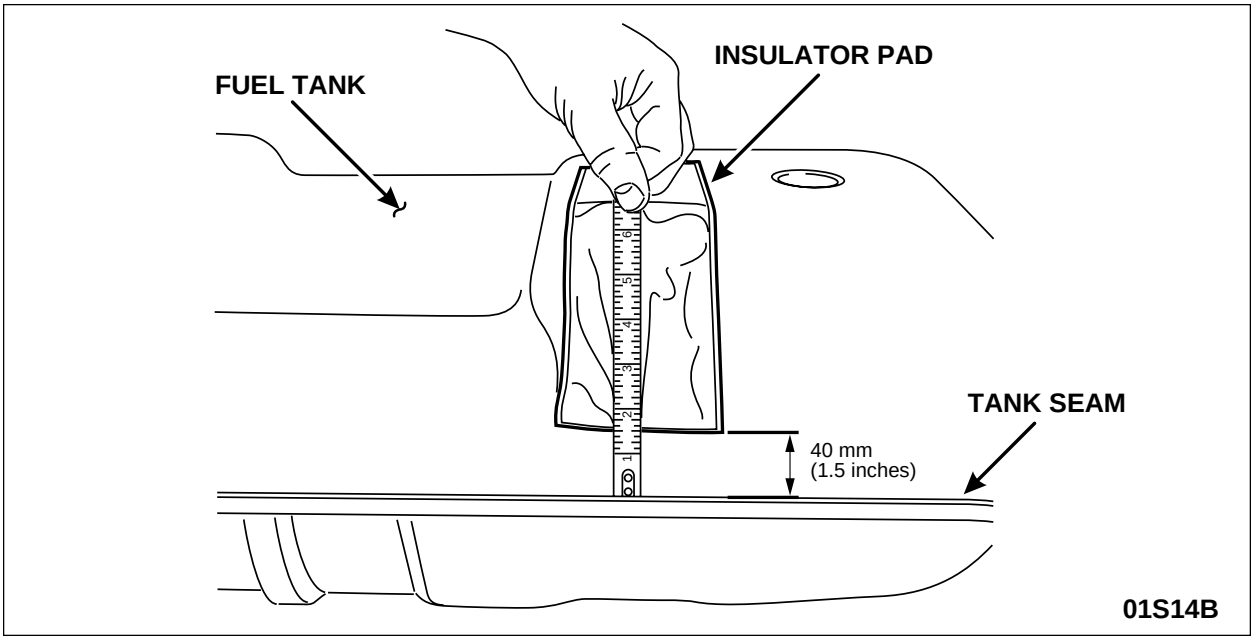

FIGURE 2

3. Proceed to FUEL TANK INSTALLATION.

FUEL TANK INSTALLATION

1. Position the fuel tank on the jack and raise it to near its installed position.
2. Connect the fuel pump and pressure transducer electrical connectors.
3. Connect the fuel pressure and return lines at the pump.
4. Install the rear vapor valve into the fuel tank and connect both vapor return valve tubes.
5. Raise the tank all the way up, then position the fuel tank straps and install the nuts. Tighten the nuts to 23 Nm (17 lb-ft). Remove the jack from under the vehicle.
6. Connect the fuel filler tube and vent tube to the hoses at the fuel pump.
7. Remove the supports and lower the vehicle.
8. Reinstall the engine cover.
9. Transfer fuel from the fuel storage tanker back into the fuel tank.
10. Turn the ignition key to ON to pressurize the fuel system and check for leaks.

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